



Ages 14 to 18

Nudes, Pressure and Threats Online: What to Do

Pressure to send nudes, images shared without consent, sextortion and online blackmail: what the law says, what to do, and how to help a friend. For all students.

Before You Read

This guide covers nude images, image-based abuse, sextortion and online blackmail.

This guide is about nude and semi-nude images: pressure to send them, images shared without consent, fake images, sextortion and other online blackmail. It doesn't show or describe any images. Some of it may be difficult to read, especially if it connects with something that has happened to you or someone close to you.

- Read it in sections, take a break, or stop whenever you need to.
- You can talk to any adult you trust at school, including the safeguarding team, a counsellor or the school nurse.
- **Childline:** 0800 1111, free and confidential, any time, day or night. You can also use 1-2-1 chat at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk), but you may have to wait for a counsellor, so calling is usually quickest.
- **Shout:** text SHOUT to 85258, free, 24/7.

If you or someone else is in immediate danger, call 999.

This Guide Is for Everyone

This guide is for **all students**. It covers:

- pressure to send nudes, including from a partner;
- nudes shared without consent, and fake or AI-made nudes;
- **sextortion:** someone threatening to share sexual images unless you pay or send more;
- other **online blackmail**, such as threats to share an old post or video;
- what to do if you're sent someone else's image, or a friend needs help.

If it's happening to you, it is not your fault, and you won't be in trouble for asking for help.

Need Help Now?

- **Tell an adult you trust:** a teacher, your tutor, a house parent or anyone at school you feel safe with.
- If someone has threatened you or someone else, **tell an adult straight away.**
- Being threatened or blackmailed? **Don't pay, don't send anything more**, stop replying, and tell an adult now, even late at night.
- If someone is in danger right now, **call 999.**
- **Childline:** 0800 1111, free, any time.

Key Words

Nudes

Nude or semi-nude photos, videos or livestreams. The term covers images someone takes of themselves, images others take, and altered or AI-made ones.

Image-based abuse

Sharing, or threatening to share, someone's intimate image without their consent.

Sextortion

Blackmail using sexual images, usually for money. Often run by organised criminals posing as young people.

Deepfake

A fake image or video made or edited with AI to look real. The harm is real even when the image isn't.

Consent

A free choice, made without pressure, threats or fear. Agreeing to send an image to one person is not agreeing to it being shared.

What the Data Shows

397

sextortion reports actioned by the IWF in 2025, across all its reporting routes, up 127% on 2024

IWF, 2025

92%

of the IWF's sextortion reports over the last three years (a wider group than the 2025 figure) involved boys

IWF, 2025

1,894

reports to Report Remove from UK under-18s in 2025

IWF, 2025

IWF figures count reports it dealt with, not every young person affected. Checked September 2026.

Sources: check them yourself

- Internet Watch Foundation, *Annual Data and Insights Report 2025: sexually coerced extortion*
- Internet Watch Foundation, *Annual Data and Insights Report 2025: executive summary*

What the Law Says

England and Wales

- Making, keeping or sharing an indecent image of anyone under 18 is a crime, even an image of yourself, and even if it is AI-made or edited (Protection of Children Act 1978; Criminal Justice Act 1988).
- Sharing someone's intimate image without consent, or **threatening** to share one, is a crime, whatever their age (Sexual Offences Act 2003, section 66B).
- Demanding money with threats can be blackmail (Theft Act 1968).
- Criminal responsibility starts at 10. The police and courts decide whether a crime has happened, not you, and not school staff.

The law is there to protect young people, not to criminalise them. If an image of you has been shared, you will not be in trouble for asking for help, at school or with the police. The police focus on keeping young people safe.

Pressure and Consent

- You never owe anyone an image, including a partner. Asking again and again, guilt-tripping, sending one first to make you feel you should, or offering money or gifts, are all pressure.
- Agreeing to send an image to one person doesn't mean agreeing to it being shared. If it is shared, the person who shared it is responsible.
- Be wary of new contacts who move fast to sexual chat, or ask to move to a private app. Offenders often pose as young people or use hacked accounts.

If a Nude of You Has Been Shared

What to Do

- **Tell a trusted adult.** They won't ask you to show them your images, and won't copy or share them. You're not in trouble.
- **Keep the messages. Don't delete them.** You don't need to save or screenshot anything: an adult can help. If you need to block someone now to feel safe, do it, and tell an adult anyway.
- **Use Report Remove** to try to get it taken down (see *Getting Images Taken Down*). If you posted it yourself, delete it from your accounts and cloud backups.
- **Don't confront** the people sharing it, or try to get it back. That's the adults' job.

Fake or AI-made nudes of you are abuse too. You don't have to prove they're fake: tell an adult.

Sextortion and Online Blackmail

If Someone Is Threatening You

- The threat might be to share a nude (real or fake), a video, or an old post, unless you pay, send more, or do something for them, such as letting them use your bank account.
- **Don't pay, and don't send anything more.** There's no guarantee it stops; once you've paid, they usually ask for more.
- **Stop all contact and block them.** Don't delete the messages or your account: deactivate it if you need to.

- **Tell a trusted adult now.** You can also report to the police (101, or 999 in an emergency) or to CEOP.
- Sextortion is usually run by organised criminals targeting many young people at once. **It is not your fault, and you are not alone.**
- If you're thinking about hurting yourself, talk to someone today: a trusted adult, **Childline** on 0800 1111, text SHOUT to 85258, or Samaritans on 116 123. If you're in danger, call 999.

Advice from the National Crime Agency.

If You're Sent Someone Else's Image

- **Don't forward, show, screenshot or save it.** Every share harms the person again, and keeping or sharing an image of an under-18 is a crime.
- **Tell a trusted adult.** They'll advise you what to do next, including about deleting it. You're not in trouble for receiving something you didn't ask for.

Getting Images Taken Down

- **Report Remove** (childline.org.uk): if you're under 18, report a nude of yourself and try to get it taken down. You need a Childline account, and Childline can support you.
- **Take It Down** (takeitdown.ncmec.org): creates a digital fingerprint so some apps can block a nude of you, even before it's shared. The image stays on your phone. It doesn't work on encrypted apps.
- **CEOP** (ceop.police.uk): report sexual blackmail, grooming or online sexual abuse to the National Crime Agency. Not for bullying or hacked accounts. In danger? Call 999.
- Report on the platform itself too. A trusted adult can help with all of these.

RESPOND: If It's Happening to Someone Else

Image-based abuse spreads through bystanders. **You lead the relational steps, Pause is the bridge, and adults lead the systems steps.**

Relational: You Lead (R, E, S)



Recognise

Notice what's happening.

- Use the 4 Ps: **People** (who's targeted?), **Places** (where is it spilling over?), **Platforms** (which chats?), **Patterns** (is it spreading, or turning into threats?)



Engage

Reach out privately.

- "I saw what's going round. Are you OK? It's not your fault."
- **If it is safe to do so**, the best options are usually to **Delegate** (tell a trusted adult), **Distract** (change the subject, or get your friend away from the group) and **Delay** (check in with them afterwards). Saying "Don't share that" directly is an option only if it won't make you a target



Support

Stay close.

- "I'm here. We can talk to someone together." Keep including them

The Bridge: Pause (P)



Pause

Think before you act.

- **Risk** (is anyone being threatened?), **Rights** (what does your friend need?), **Resources** (who can help?)
- **Don't open, share, screenshot or comment on the image**, even to defend someone. You're not expected to investigate or collect evidence

Systems: Adults Lead (O, N, D)



Offer

Model alternatives. Signpost help.

- Show a different way: don't share it, say it's not OK if you safely can, and point your friend to Report Remove and a trusted adult



Notify

Tell a trusted adult.

- **Threats and blackmail: tell an adult straight away.** It isn't snitching



Document

Adults record it.

- The adult makes the record. Tell them what you know, and where



What Happens When You Tell

What Happens When You Tell

- **It starts with a person you trust. Behind them is a system:** a safeguarding team, records and procedures that make sure what you tell one person reaches the people who can help. The person is why young people tell; the system is why telling works.
 - You'll be listened to and taken seriously.
 - They won't ask you to show them your images, and won't copy or share them. The safeguarding team makes a plan to keep you safe, and helps get images taken down.
 - The adult will pass it to the safeguarding team. They won't promise to keep it secret, and they'll tell you what they are doing.
 - The law allows schools to share information needed to keep a young person safe without asking for consent, and from 30 September 2026 a new legal duty requires many safeguarding organisations to share it. What is shared must be relevant and proportionate, go only to the people who need it, and be handled in line with data protection law. Because your consent isn't the legal basis, they won't ask for it as if it were. They should tell you what they are sharing, with whom and why, unless that would put someone at risk, and listen to what you think. Agreeing to support, such as counselling, is a separate choice, and your views matter there.
 - You'll have as much say as possible in the plan and the support you get.
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- Parents or carers are usually told, and the school will talk with you about how. If home isn't safe, tell the adult: they'll think carefully about how, and whether, your family is told.
 - The police may be involved, especially for threats or blackmail. Their focus is keeping you safe.

If You've Been Part of It

Forwarding an image, making a fake one, pressuring someone, or threatening to share something causes serious harm, and can be a crime.

- Stop, don't share it further, and talk to an adult you trust. Owning it early is better than being found out.
- **Shore (Lucy Faithfull Foundation):** anonymous advice for teenagers worried about their own sexual behaviour online or offline, including sharing nudes, at shorespace.org.uk.
- **Childline** (0800 1111) is there for you too.

Myths and Facts

Myth	Fact
"If I pay, it'll stop"	Paying rarely ends it; they usually ask for more. Don't pay: get help.
"I'll be in trouble with the police"	The law is there to protect young people, and asking for help is always the right thing to do. The school's first concern is your safety: you'll be supported, not blamed. If the police become involved, they decide about any offences, and school will support you through it.
"They sent it, so it's their fault"	Sending an image to one person isn't consent to share it. The person who shares it is responsible.
"It's fake, so it's harmless"	Deepfake nudes cause real harm, and making or sharing them can be a crime.
"Nothing can be done once it's online"	Report Remove and Take It Down can help get images removed or blocked.

If You Board

- You can always contact your house parents, the DSL or a member of the boarding management team, at any time, day or night.
- If something happens at night, tell the house parent on duty straight away, even late. You don't have to wait until morning.
- Your boarding school has an independent person you can talk to who isn't a member of staff.
- You can always contact your family privately.

Who Can Help

At School

- Any adult you trust: your tutor or advisor, your head of year, a teacher, a coach, a house parent if you board, or a school counsellor
- **The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)** and deputy DSLs: the staff whose job is to keep students safe. Their names are usually on the school website, in the safeguarding policy and on posters around school.
- The school nurse or health centre, and the school counsellor

Outside School

- **Childline (for anyone under 19)**: 0800 1111, free and confidential; call any time, day or night, or use 1-2-1 chat at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk) (you may have to wait for a chat counsellor, so calling is usually quickest). **If you're under 18, start here.**
- **Shout**: text **SHOUT** to 85258, free, confidential, 24/7
- **Samaritans**: 116 123, free, any time, day or night
- **Police**: 999 if someone is in immediate danger; 101 to report sextortion or blackmail that is not an emergency

RESPOND Safeguarding Framework Student Guides

Nudes, Pressure and Threats Online: What to Do: Student Guide 10 - 14 to 18

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